

Dopamine on mice

Scientists find a way to manipulate mice and make them lose track of time. Learn more here: <http://digit.in/dopamineM>

**New Bluetooth 5**

New Bluetooth 5 said to bring a better support for IOT, increased speeds and better range. <http://digit.in/Bluetooth5>

Prasid Banerjee
prasid@digit.in

The OnePlus 3 was launched about half-a-year ago, and OnePlus has already brought forth an upgrade, with the OnePlus 3T. Why? The company says it's because it saw some room for improvement. We spoke to Pete Lau, Founder, OnePlus, asking for some explanations on this, his take on VR, their strategy for flagships and more on those lines.

Q The obvious question first. Why did you upgrade the OnePlus 3 so soon?

Lau: The OnePlus 3 has been launched for almost half a year, and we thought we needed to improve on the product which is why we did it.

Q When we met Carl Pei last time, he had said you guys worked really hard to make the OnePlus 3 perfect. So, how does the new hardware make it better?

Lau: Technology is always developing fast. When we launched the OnePlus 3, there was no Snapdragon 821. Now there is, and the CPU performance actually increased by about 10% and the GPU performance by about 5%. Some people may think that this isn't a huge improvement, but we yearn for perfection, and if we think even if we can add a little bit, then we will.

The biggest change on the OnePlus 3T is in the battery. It has changed from 3,000 mAh to 3,400 mAh, and the size didn't change. The phone is as light-weight, but the battery performance is two hours more. It took us almost half a year's work for this battery. In the choice of the battery, we are like the most conservative. Our principle is that the current battery has been used for almost half a year, and while there's no problem with it, this new one is now ready, so we can use it.

Q But OnePlus is a fan-oriented company, and you're telling them that you launched a new phone half a year ago, they bought it and you've now



Pete Lau, CEO, OnePlus

**OnePlus
3T loads
games
48%
faster than
Galaxy S7
Edge:
Pete Lau**

The OnePlus 3T replaces the OnePlus 3 atop the company's portfolio. What's the big idea here?



upgraded it. How do you justify it to those fans?

Lau: We actually listened to our fans. When we launched OnePlus 3, some fans liked Dash Charge, but they also wondered if the battery could last longer. So, taking that feedback from our consumers, we decided to use this new battery. For fans who are already using the OnePlus 3, I don't think there is a need to upgrade. But, if a person doesn't have a OnePlus phone, the OnePlus 3T is the best phone to buy.

Q From the OnePlus One to OnePlus 3, you're now better known, but you still cater to your fans. Do you have any plans to ever cater to the first time buyers, which India has a huge number of?

Lau: Of course, we will cater to those new customers. But, having said that, the fans are still our first focus. Our brand and reputation is spread from mouth-to-mouth, so their loyalty is very important to us.

Q Last year you hit two different price brackets, with the OnePlus 2 and OnePlus X. Then you said you'll stop that and follow a one flagship strategy, but this year again we have two phones. So where is it headed? Are you going to hit different price brackets soon?

Lau: We won't continue with the OnePlus X series. We had an interview with some of our fans, and they said they wouldn't buy the OnePlus X. They said our brand positioning is in the premium market, so they'll only buy our flagship phones. OnePlus represents the best of flagship smartphones, so even if we have those lower ranged devices, our fans don't want to buy them anymore.

Q Ok, coming back to the OnePlus 3T. You said it brings a 10% improvement, which is what Qualcomm also says for the Snapdragon 821. But does it also bring Daydream VR support?

No, VR isn't the reason for adding the Snapdragon 821. I don't see VR headsets having a very promising future. **Q**